



## TWITTERATI RUSH

WHEN ELON MUSK acquired a little over 9 per cent in Twitter, it caught the fancy of several Indian retail investors who invest in US-listed companies. Platforms that allow Indians to invest overseas reported a significant jump in trading volume with some reporting up to a nine-fold rise in the number of investors buying Twitter shares. The day Musk's acquisition was disclosed, April 4, Twitter shares had gained over 29 per cent. —ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

# ₹5.88

## LAKH CRORE

**TOTAL AMOUNT  
OF FUNDRAISING  
THROUGH  
PRIVATE  
PLACEMENT  
OF CORPORATE  
BONDS BY  
LISTED  
COMPANIES  
FOR THE FISCAL  
YEAR 2021-22, A  
SIX-YEAR LOW**

14 |



## RIDING ON RAPIDO

**Food delivery decacorn**

Swiggy led a \$180-million funding into bike-taxi start-up Rapido, which values the latter at over \$800 million. Besides bolstering their existing partnership, where Rapido's riders fulfil Swiggy orders, the deal helps Swiggy strengthen its 'neighbourhood convenience economy' play while allowing both companies to effectively utilise their delivery fleets.

—BINU PAUL

## SOYA SAUCE

Baba Ramdev-led Patanjali Ayurved has finally unfolded its plans to leverage its Ruchi Soya acquisition. After successfully launching its follow-on public offer (FPO), it announced a renaming of the entity to Patanjali Foods Ltd. The latest move is aimed at bringing the group's business and placing its packaged food and beverages portfolio under one roof—including the edible oil portfolio, branded commodities like wheat, flour and pulses; fruit juices and beverage; spices, jams and ketchup; cow ghee, honey, chyawanprash, dry fruits; and herbal-medicinal juices and extracts, among others.

—ARNAB DUTTA

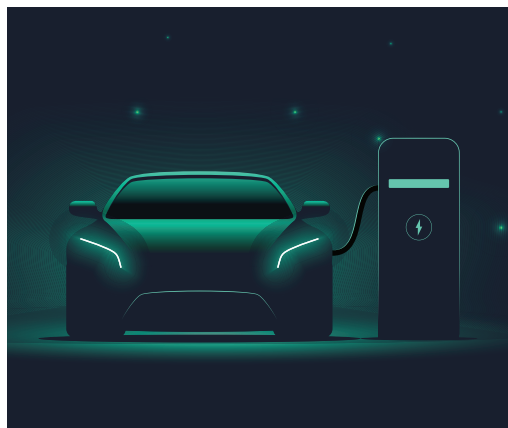


PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH

## The EV Opportunity

THE RAPID SURGE in the sales of electric vehicles (EVs) has opened up a ₹3-lakh crore business opportunity for manufacturers and supplementing sectors. A report by CRISIL says EVs offer a potential revenue of ₹1.5 lakh crore across vehicle segments for manufacturers alone till 2026. For lenders, it is a ₹90,000-crore vehicle finance opportunity, with shared mobility and insurance accounting for the balance. Hemal Thakkar, Director, CRISIL Ltd, says improving cost parity and the government's thrust may take EV penetration to 15 per cent in two-wheelers, 25-30 per cent in three-wheelers, and 5 per cent each in cars and buses by fiscal 2026.

—ARNAB DUTTA



## NEW CREW ON DECK

**Air India Chairman**

N. Chandrasekaran has repositioned some personnel in the airline—Vinod Hejmadi (from director, finance to CFO), Meenakshi Malik (from director, commercial, to advisor to CEO for commercial and technology); and Amrita Sharan (from director, HR to advisor to CEO for HR). Some fresh blood is also coming in—Tata Sons' Nipun Aggarwal as chief commercial officer and Suresh Dutt Tripathy as CHRO, and more.

—ARNAB DUTTA